

REACT JS VS NEXT JS



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



Both React.js and Next.js are powerful tools for building web applications, but they have different strengths and use cases.



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



PURPOSE

REACT JS

- A JavaScript library for building user interfaces, mainly for single-page applications.
- Concentrates on the view layer of the application

NEXT JS

- A React framework that offers a more complete solution for building web applications.
- Includes additional features such as server-side rendering, static site generation, and API routes.



Burhan Tahir



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RENDERING

REACT JS

Client-Side Rendering (CSR):
React.js primarily uses client-side rendering, meaning the JavaScript code is executed in the browser, rendering the content on the client side after the initial page load.



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



RENDERING

NEXT JS

- **Server-Side Rendering (SSR):**
Next.js can render pages on the server, sending fully rendered HTML to the client, improving performance and SEO.
- **Static Site Generation (SSG):**
Next.js can pre-render pages at build time, creating static HTML files that can be served quickly.
- **Client-Side Rendering (CSR):**
Next.js also supports client-side rendering like React.js for dynamic content.



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



ROUTING

REACT JS

- **React Router:** React.js does not have built-in routing. Developers often use the React Router library to implement routing, allowing for the creation of dynamic and nested routes within a single-page application.
- **Manual Configuration:** Developers must manually set up and configure routes in the application.



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



ROUTING

NEXT JS

- File-Based Routing: Next.js includes built-in file-based routing. Each file in the pages directory automatically becomes a route.
- Dynamic Routing: Next.js supports dynamic routing with file and folder naming conventions, making it easier to manage and understand the routes in your application.
- API Routes: Next.js also allows the creation of API endpoints with file-based routing in the pages/api directory.



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CONFIGURATION AND SETUP

REACT JS

- Manual Setup: Setting up a React.js project typically involves manual configuration. Developers often use tools like Create React App (CRA) to streamline the initial setup, which includes configuring Webpack, Babel, and other tools.

NEXT JS

- Automatic Configuration: Next.js comes with built-in configurations, providing a zero-config setup out of the box. This includes support for Webpack, Babel, TypeScript, and more.



Burhan Tahir



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PERFORMANCE

REACT JS

- React.js primarily uses client-side rendering, which can slow initial load times and require manual performance optimizations, and its client-side content rendering can limit SEO effectiveness.

NEXT JS

- Next.js enhances performance and SEO with server-side rendering, static site generation, automatic code splitting, built-in image optimization, and various out-of-the-box optimizations.



Burhan Tahir



@iamshekhobaba



API ROUTES

REACT JS

- No Built-In Support: React.js does not provide built-in support for API routes. Developers need to set up a separate backend server (e.g., using Node.js with Express) to handle API requests.
- Custom Configuration: Developers must manually configure and integrate their backend server with the React.js frontend, often using tools like Axios or Fetch for making HTTP requests.



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API ROUTES

NEXT JS

- Built-In API Routes: Next.js includes built-in support for API routes. You can create API endpoints by adding files to the `pages/api` directory.
- Serverless Functions: Next.js API routes are serverless functions that run on-demand, simplifying the process of creating and deploying backend functionality without needing a separate server setup.
- Next.js seamlessly integrates API routes with the frontend, simplifying data fetching and handling in a unified project structure.



Burhan Tahir



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